

1. Graphics Card (GPU)

- **Why upgrade:** The GPU is the heavy lifter for gaming. It takes the raw data and physically draws the stadium, the detailed player faces, and the dynamic lighting onto your screen dozens of times a second. If your game looks choppy or you have to drop the graphics settings to "Low," your GPU is likely the culprit.
- **The target:** To play FC 26/27 smoothly at high settings (1080p resolution), you want to aim for at least an **Nvidia GTX 1660** or **AMD RX 5600 XT**.

2. Processor (CPU)

- **Why upgrade:** While the GPU handles the visuals, the CPU runs the actual game logic. It calculates the ball physics, manages the AI of the 21 other players on the pitch, and processes your controller inputs. If your CPU is too slow, the game will stutter and freeze momentarily during chaotic moments (like a crowded penalty box), regardless of how powerful your graphics card is.
- **The target:** EA recommends at least an **Intel Core i7-6700** or an **AMD Ryzen 7 2700X**.

3. RAM (Memory)

- **Why upgrade:** RAM is your PC's high-speed workbench. It holds all the active game assets ready so the CPU and GPU can access them instantly. If you don't have enough RAM, your PC is forced to pull data directly from your storage drive mid-match, causing massive lag spikes.
- **The target:** 8 GB is the absolute bare minimum just to launch the game, but upgrading to **16 GB of RAM** is highly recommended to keep the notoriously heavy Ultimate Team menus snappy and the gameplay completely smooth.

4. Storage Drive (SSD)

- **Why upgrade:** If you are currently installing games on an older, mechanical Hard Disk Drive (HDD), upgrading to a Solid State Drive (SSD) is a game-changer. An SSD won't increase your frame rate, but it uses flash memory to load files instantly. It will drastically reduce how long you stare at loading screens before a match starts.
- **The target:** The game requires about 100 GB of free space. A modern **M.2 NVMe SSD** is the standard for fast loading.